English First Paper

[N.B.-The figures in the right margin indicate full marks.]

Time - 3 hours **Marks - 100**

Part-A: Reading (Marks-70)

Read the text and answer the questions 1 & 2:

A large number of Bangladeshis go abroad for work. There is always a high demand for workers in countries like the UAE, Oman, Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Bahrain, etc. These countries prefer Bangladeshi workers because they are hard-working. However, it is unfortunate that many of our workers are forced to do "odd" jobs in those countries, and as a result, they are not paid well. One reason for this is that Bangladeshi workers are often not good at English, Arabic or other languages which are required abroad. Therefore, it is important for workers to develop their language skills before going to other countries for work. This will help them secure better jobs and receive the pay and benefits they deserve. In this way, they will be able to support their families better, as well as contribute more effectively to the development of our economy.

1. Choose the best answer from the alternatives. $1 \times 7 = 7$

(a) Where do a large number of Bangladeshis go?
(i) Abroad for work (ii) To school (iii) To villages (iv) To markets
(b) What is always high for workers abroad?
(i) Salary (ii) Demand (iii) Population (iv) Education
(c) Which of the following countries hire Bangladeshi workers?
(i) UAE, Oman, Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Bahrain (ii) India, China, Japan (iii) USA, Canada, Australia (iv) Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar
(d) What kind of contribution can foreign workers make?
(i) Cultural change only (ii) Political development (iii) Religious development (iv) Economic development of Bangladesh
(e) Why do these countries prefer Bangladeshi workers?
(i) They are educated (ii) They are rich (iii) They are lazy (iv) They are hard-working
(f) What is the main idea of the passage?
(i) Importance of language skills (ii) Tourism in the Middle East (iii) Education in Bangladesh (iv) Hard work of farmers
(g) What can better pay and jobs help them do?
i) Waste money (ii) Support their families (iii) Leave work early (iv) Buy luxury cars only

2. Write short answers to the following questions: $2 \times 5 = 10$

(a) Who go abroad for jobs?
(b) Why do they like Bangladeshi workers?
(c) What is a matter of regret?
(d) Why should we develop the language skills of our workers?
(e) What can the wage earners do to our country?

Read the text and answer the questions 3 & 4:

Mobile phones

Mobile phone is another useful invention of the world. Like computers mobile phones help us greatly in our daily life. Through mobile we can connect the whole world. Only a few years ago we had difficulty to contact our near and dear ones. That was very costly too. Mobile phones are very handy and we can use them for communication with people at a very low cost. Mobile phones have different functions such as making calls, listening to music, taking photographs, storing information, etc. Even it can be used for distance learning.

3. Complete the passage with suitable words: $1 \times 5 = 5$

The mobile phone is a (a) ------- invention. It plays an important role in our daily lives. It allows us to connect (b) ------ people worldwide. It is (c) ------- and serves multiple purposes, such as making calls, listening to music, taking photographs, and storing (d) -----. Moreover, it can also be used for distance (e) -------, making them even more beneficial in modern life.

4. Read the passage carefully and replace the following words with their suitable synonyms or antonyms: $1 \times 5 = 5$

(a) Difficult (antonym) (b) Near (antonym) (c) Dear (synonym) (d) Costly (antonym) (e) Handy (synonym)

Read the text and answer the questions 5, 6 & 7:

Zaman's father has a small plot of land behind their house. He cultivates different types of vegetables there. Every morning, he goes to the garden with his tools and works happily. He grows brinjal, tomato, spinach, pumpkin, and beans. Sometimes Zaman helps his father by watering the plants and removing weeds. They use natural fertilizer made from cow dung to keep the soil rich. Zaman's mother also helps by collecting vegetables for cooking. The family enjoys eating fresh and healthy food from their own garden. On weekends, Zaman's friends come to see the plants and learn about gardening. His father says that growing vegetables not only saves money but also keeps people healthy. The garden makes their home beautiful and green.

5. Complete the table with information from the passage. $1 \times 5 = 5$

Topic	**Information from the passage**
a) The location of the small plot of land	i) ————
b) The types of vegetables grown in the garden	ii) ————
c) The material used as natural fertilizer to keep the soil rich	iii) ————
d) Who comes to see the plants and learn about gardening on weekends	iv) ————
e) The two main benefits of growing vegetables according to Zaman's father	v) ————

6. Write 'True' if the statement is correct and 'False' if it is incorrect. If false, write the correct answer. $1 \times 5 = 5$

(a) Zaman's father has a small plot of land in front of their house.
(b) Zaman helps his father by watering the plants and removing weeds.
(c) They use chemical fertilizers to keep the soil rich.
(d) Zaman's mother helps by cooking the vegetables.
(e) Growing vegetables saves money and keeps people healthy.

7. Write a summary of the passage in your own words. **10**

8. Match the parts of sentences from Column A and Column B to make five complete sentences. **$1 \times 5 = 5$**

Column A	**Column B**
a) Once, a lion was	i) over the face of the lion.
b) Suddenly, a mouse came	ii) angry and caught the mouse.
c) It was running	iii) there.
d) By chance, it ran	iv) to and fro and playing happily.
e) The lion became	v) sleeping in a forest.

9. Put the following parts of the story in the correct order to make the whole story. Only the corresponding numbers of the sentences need to be written. **1×8=8**

a) He was puzzled for a time.
b) The Queen of Sheba also heard of his wealth and wisdom, and so, she came to test him.
c) She brought with her two garlands of flowers one natural and the other artificial.
d) Everyone will have heard the name of Solomon who was famous for his wealth and wisdom.
e) He noticed some bees humming for honey in a withered rose outside the window and asked one of his men to open the windows.
f) She placed them before the king and asked him to pick up the natural one.
g) The bees came in and settled on the natural flowers, and thus, solved the problem.
h) The Queen of Sheba became surprised and went away admiring the king.

10. Answer any five of the following questions from the poems in your textbook. **$2 \times 5 = 10$**

a) What was in the eyes of the speaker's friend?
b) What did the friend want?
c) What did the speaker say he had to try to do?
d) Who is the speaker asking to help save lives?
e) What is happening to many people in Bangladesh?
f) How does the speaker describe the situation in the country?
g) What does the speaker ask people to lend?
h) What does the speaker want people to say instead of turning away?

Part-B: Writing (Marks-30)

11. Read the opening of a story below and complete it in at least ten new sentences. Give a suitable title to it. **10**

Once an old farmer had three sons. They .....

12. Write a paragraph on 'Tree Plantation' in 120 words. **10**

13. Write a dialogue between two friends about “Significance of Early Rising”. **10**